

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals
N-S Vul

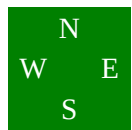
♠ 10 9 7 4
♥ 8 7
♦ 8 5 3
♣ K Q 5 2

♠ A Q 5

♥ Q 10 9 3

♦ A J 10 7

♣ A 8



♠ K 8 3

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 3

♠ J 6 2

♥ A K J 6 4 2

♦ K

♣ J 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
slim possibility that partner has only one Ace!

Your partnership may play that a jump to 3♥ shows a 6-card suit with slam interest, in other words, this very hand. If you do, then bid it. If you don't, use a transfer first. Let's say you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 3♥. Now

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You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least two Aces for his strong bidding. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and this is certainly not the type of hand where asking for Aces is always helpful - what if partner shows two Aces, aren't you going to bid the slam anyway? The advantage to Blackwood here is that there is just a

You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♠. Next?

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The contract would be 6♥ played by South.

North plays 6♥. East leads the ♣10. You play the ♣J, just in case East made a mistake, but West puts on the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

The ♠ loser is deceptive. You could discard a ♠ from dummy on your ♦A, but would still have a ♠ loser if the finesse doesn't work. Still, this would be one possible plan. Can you improve on that?

Maybe you can. Look harder at the ♦s. Win the ♣A, then play to dummy's ♦K. Pull trumps (2 rounds) ending in your hand. Play your ♦A, but discard a ♣ from dummy, (the key play). Now play your ♦J, and if East plays low, discard dummy's other ♣.

You have gotten rid of the ♣ losers, but if West can win the ♦Q on this trick you will discard a ♠ on the ♦10, but will still have to try the ♠ finesse.

But, if the ♦J holds then it won't matter if the ♠ finesse works or not, you will make the slam.

Suppose when you play your ♦J East puts on the ♦Q.

No problem. You ruff in dummy, come back to your hand with a trump and **THEN** discard dummy's last ♣

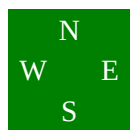
Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ 7 4 2
 ♦ Q 10 9
 ♣ 8 5 4 2

♠ Q 9 5
 ♥ K Q 8 6 3
 ♦ K 6 2
 ♣ A 3



♠ A J 2
 ♥ A 10 5
 ♦ A J 7
 ♣ J 9 7 6

♠ 10 8 7 4
 ♥ J 9
 ♦ 8 5 4 3
 ♣ K Q 10

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	1NT	
All Pass			
1NT by East			

With no reason to think you could improve the contract you just pass.

The contract would be 1NT played by West.

East plays 1NT. South leads the ♥J and North plays the ♥8. Do you hold up? If so, how many times?

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 4

It probably makes no difference whether you hold up or not since North surely has most of the high cards. However, holding up once is a good idea because South may have a singleton ♥ and have to switch to something which helps you. South holds the first trick and plays another ♥, which you win.

You must find 4 winners. The bad news is that you must finesse both the ♦K and the ♠Q. The good news is that with North opening the bidding there is a good chance he has both of them. So, how will you manage those two finesses?

There is only one way to do it. Enter dummy with the only entry, the ♠K. Take the ♦ finesse first - play the ♦Q and unblock your ♦J when North plays low. (you could play the ♦10/♦7 combination first).

Finesse the ♦ again. If North ducks a second time you must now take the ♠ finesse while you are still in dummy. If North covers the second ♦ you win with your ♦A, return to dummy with the ♦9, and then finesse the ♠.

Having used dummy's lone entry to get there in the first place you have to make sure you take the finesse that permits you to either remain in dummy, or to return if North plays his King.

And you have to be careful to unblock so you don't inadvertently lose your place in dummy too soon.